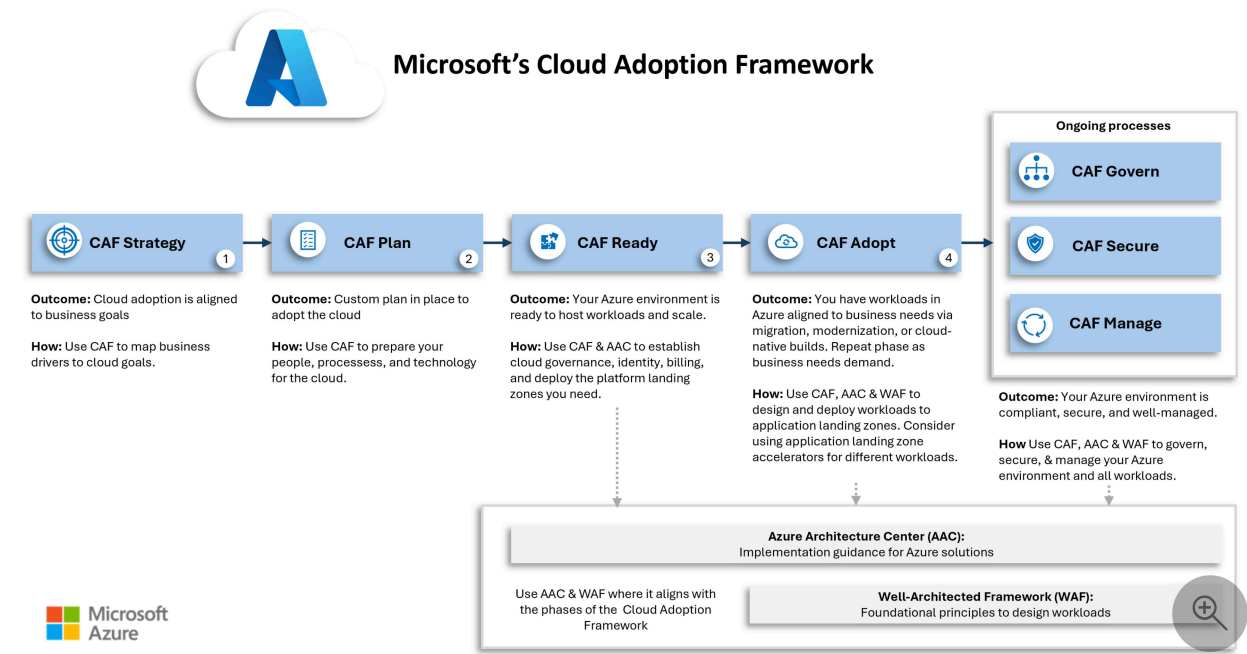


What is the Microsoft Cloud Adoption Framework?

 Summarize this article for me

The Microsoft Cloud Adoption Framework (CAF) is a structured roadmap that helps organizations successfully adopt Azure and integrate it into their existing IT environments. It provides best practices and guidance to help organizations make the right decisions for their business throughout the cloud journey.



How does the Cloud Adoption Framework work?

The Cloud Adoption Framework organizes Azure guidance into seven core methodologies that together guide an organization's cloud journey. The foundational methodologies (Strategy, Plan, Ready, and Adopt) are sequential. They help you define business outcomes, prepare your organization and environment, and deploy workloads to Azure. These phases are where most organizations start and are revisited as cloud adoption matures. Once workloads are running in Azure, the operational methodologies (Govern, Secure, and Manage) define different aspects of your cloud operations that help ensure your Azure environment remains compliant, protected, and optimized over time.

 Expand table

CAF methodology (phases)	Outcome	How
 1. Strategy	Cloud adoption aligned to business goals	Map business drivers to cloud outcomes.
 2. Plan	A plan for cloud adoption	Operating model, cloud skills, migration plan, and cloud cost estimation.
 3. Ready	An Azure environment ready for workloads	Azure purchasing, tenant setup, platform landing zone, application landing zones.
 4. Adopt	Workloads in Azure meeting business needs	Migrate, modernize, or build-cloud native workloads.
 5. Govern	Control workloads	Assess cloud risks and mitigate with Azure and Microsoft tools.
 6. Secure	Protect workloads	Apply security control with with Azure and Microsoft tools.
 7. Manage	Optimize workloads	Administer workloads with Azure and Microsoft tools.

Why use the Cloud Adoption Framework?

The Cloud Adoption Framework is about adopting cloud technologies and integrating them into your business. It provides proven practices to govern, secure, and manage all workloads. It provides structured processes for migrating, modernizing, and building cloud-native solutions. Throughout each stage of adoption, the framework guides you to the right tools, architectures, and other resources to help you achieve your organizational goals. The framework integrates with the [Well-Architected Framework](#) and [Azure Architecture Center](#).

Who is the Cloud Adoption Framework for?

The Microsoft Cloud Adoption Framework serves organizations across all industries and scales pursuing strategic Azure cloud adoption. This framework adapts to your specific cloud maturity level, from initial Azure evaluation through advanced multicloud optimization strategies. It's designed for anyone in the organization responsible for technology adoption, whether that responsibility spans business strategy, technology governance, cloud integration, or day-to-day operations.

Organization Type	How the framework accelerates success
Startups	Build cloud-native applications using best practices. Access Microsoft for Startups for Azure credits and technical resources.
Enterprise	Establish a governance foundation to control workloads at enterprise scale.

Cloud Adoption Framework scenarios

The Cloud Adoption Framework has specific guidance aligned to common scenarios across our customer base.

 Expand table

CAF Scenario	Purpose
Data	How to unify your data platform for AI and analytics
AI agents	How and when to adopt AI agents
AI adoption	How to adopt AI (generative and nongenerative)
Azure Virtual Desktop	How to adopt Azure Virtual Desktop
Azure VMware Solution	How to adopt Azure VMware Solution
Cloud-Scale Analytics	How to do analytics in the cloud
Oracle on Azure	Run Oracle workloads on Azure.
SAP on Azure	How to run SAP workloads on Azure

Last updated on 01/26/2026

What's new in Microsoft's Cloud Adoption Framework

Microsoft's Cloud Adoption Framework is continuously updated with new guidance, enhanced content, and refined recommendations based on customer experiences and evolving cloud practices. This page helps you stay informed about the latest updates, new resources, deprecated content, and where to find specific information as the framework evolves.

April 2026

Deprecation notice

Select application landing zone accelerator articles in the Cloud Adoption Framework are deprecated. This deprecation applies only to the Cloud Adoption Framework guidance articles for the following application landing zone accelerators: [Azure Integration Services](#), [Azure Kubernetes Services](#), [Azure API Management](#), [Azure App Service](#), and [Azure Container Apps](#).

These articles will remain available on Microsoft Learn until May 20, 2026. After this date, the Cloud Adoption Framework versions of these articles will be removed. This change applies solely to the guidance in the Cloud Adoption Framework. If your organization currently references this Cloud Adoption Framework content, take any necessary steps to retain information for your own records prior to the removal date. There are directions provided in the existing guidance. Use the links above to navigate there.

The Cloud Adoption Framework provides organization-level decision guidance. Architecture and workload design guidance is provided through the Azure Architecture Center and the Microsoft Well-Architected Framework, which remain the primary sources for alternative architecture guidance.

March 2026

New guidance

Unify your data platform for AI and analytics: CAF has new guidance on how to unify your data platform with Microsoft Fabric. This guidance helps decision makers organize operating models around data domains, define clear data ownership and accountability, and establish

standards for secure and governed data products. It also explains how high-quality data products support AI and analytics across the organization.

Deprecation notice

Cloud-scale analytics guidance is deprecated. We replaced this guidance with [Unify your data platform for AI and analytics](#). The deprecation and deletion date is April 30, 2026. To keep a copy of the retired content, navigate to the [content](#) to download a PDF or download the source files from [GitHub](#) [↗](#).

December 2025

New guidance

[AI agent adoption guidance for organizations](#): Discover how to adopt AI agents effectively by using a step-by-step framework for planning, governance, integration, and measurement that maximizes business impact.

Updated articles

- [Security control mapping with Azure landing zone](#): We improved clarity and readability throughout the article, simplified terminology for the Microsoft Cloud Security Benchmark, and updated implementation guidance to reference Azure Verified Modules for Terraform and Bicep deployments.
- [Azure landing zone frequently asked questions \(FAQs\)](#): We broadened sovereign landing zone guidance to apply to all organizations that have sovereignty needs rather than only government organizations.
- [Encryption and key management in Azure](#): We added guidance about choosing the right Azure key management solution. We enhanced Key Vault recommendations by clarifying when to use Azure Key Vault Managed HSM for centralized scenarios and explaining the benefits of multiple key vaults.
- [Azure workload management and monitoring](#): We added guidance about using Azure service groups to organize workload resources across subscriptions and resource groups. We introduced health models in Azure Monitor (preview) to define and track resource health.

- [Migrate Azure landing zone custom policies to Azure built-in policies](#): We simplified the policy migration guidance by consolidating references to Azure Verified Modules for Terraform and Bicep update guides and removing redundant step-by-step instructions.
- [Overview of network topology and connectivity for Azure](#): We improved readability by adding better formatting to the Connectivity, Corp, and Online management group descriptions. We added a tip that simplifies understanding the Corp (internal-facing) and Online (public-facing) management groups.
- [Subscription considerations and recommendations](#): We enhanced platform subscription guidance to include a separate dedicated security subscription and emphasized not combining platform responsibilities into a single subscription. We added recommendations for quota management using quota groups and automation. We also introduced an operational excellence section that includes Azure Service Health guidance.
- [Update Azure landing zone custom policies](#): We simplified policy update guidance by consolidating Bicep update instructions and updating references to Azure Verified Modules for Terraform and Bicep.
- [Independent software vendor \(ISV\) considerations for Azure landing zones](#): We added a recommendation for ISVs to include a separate Security management group under the Platform management group. We noted that we plan to add the Security management group to future updates.
- [Platform landing zone implementation options](#): We restructured the article to focus specifically on platform landing zone implementation and simplified guidance to two main approaches. It includes the recommended infrastructure as code (IaC) accelerator with a detailed four-phase approach, and the portal-based accelerator. We replaced multiple implementation variants with improved options and enhanced Azure Verified Modules guidance for both Bicep and Terraform.
- [What is an Azure landing zone?](#): We restructured deployment guidance to emphasize the IaC accelerator as the recommended approach. We enhanced application landing zone descriptions with subscription vending details and clarified the *landing zone P1 subscription* purpose.
- [Manage your cloud estate with enhanced security](#): We added guidance to review Microsoft Secure Future Initiative requirements and integrate them into security assessments.

- [Assess your workloads for cloud migration](#): We replaced AppCAT references with the GitHub Copilot app modernization tool and detailed its capabilities, including dependency capture, code revision, containerization, deployment file generation, and AI-assisted coding.
- [Security teams, roles, and functions](#): We added a new section about minimum viable security teams for small organizations and enhanced explanations about how security roles transform with cloud adoption and modern development practices.

November 2025

Updated articles

- [Govern Azure platform as a service \(PaaS\) solutions for AI](#): We improved explanations of key concepts like provisioned throughput units (PTUs), retrieval-augmented generation (RAG), and role-based access control (RBAC) by adding definitions and practical examples. We also reorganized content into clearer steps and added concrete examples, like using a generative AI gateway to manage costs and implementing version control for training datasets.
- [Security considerations for the Azure Integration Services landing zone accelerator](#): We updated the integration services security guidance to fix typos, correct grammatical errors, and improve consistency. We also cleaned up link formatting by removing unnecessary URL parameters.
- [Business continuity and disaster recovery for Azure Virtual Desktop](#): We clarified the active-active host pool section by explaining the two-region setup with user assignment and failover procedures, and we added guidance about FSLogix profile storage behavior in the active-passive scenario.
- [Manage your cloud estate with enhanced security](#): We improved formatting consistency and clarity. We enhanced the business continuity and disaster recovery recommendation by clarifying the distinction between disaster recovery planning and resilient architecture design with more precise, actionable language.
- [Prepare your secure cloud estate](#): We improved terminology and formatting. We changed *resiliency* to *reliability* throughout the availability section to align with Well-Architected Framework terminology. We also clarified the distinction between resilience patterns and recoverability mechanisms in the design recommendation, and standardized spacing between bullet points for better readability.

October 2025

Updated articles

- [Microsoft Cloud Adoption Framework for Azure](#): We improved readability and logical flow. We moved the methodology explanation to appear earlier in the article, reorganized the foundational and operational methodology sections for better clarity, and simplified the organization type table. We also removed promotional language throughout to focus on practical guidance for Azure adoption.
- [Ready your Azure environment for workloads](#): We updated the Ready methodology to focus specifically on Azure landing zones. We clarified guidance for platform versus application landing zones and improved the structured four-phase implementation journey. We replaced generic landing zone concepts with detailed explanations of subscription vending, governance setup, and workload deployment patterns. We improved the navigation to guide users directly to Azure landing zone implementation rather than general setup guidance.
- [Azure Arc connectivity design for Oracle Exadata Database@Azure](#): We added guidance for using Microsoft Entra ID to manage Secure Shell (SSH) authentication and privileged access monitoring on Azure Arc-enabled Oracle Exadata cluster nodes. We updated the article to include detailed steps to enable centralized identity verification, configure role-based access control (RBAC) policies, deploy Azure Monitor agents, and implement security auditing for SSH access and privileged actions.
- [Hybrid identity with Active Directory and Microsoft Entra ID in Azure landing zones](#): We updated this guidance to emphasize modern authentication practices and added security warnings about legacy authentication mechanisms. We reorganized content sections for improved clarity, enhanced recommendations about protecting domain controllers, and added guidance for Azure Arc integration with identity services.
- [Application identity and access management](#): We expanded the introduction to clarify coverage of both component-to-component authentication and user identity management, reorganized content sections for better logical flow, and enhanced design considerations with questions about user types and authentication service compatibility.
- [Landing zone identity and access management](#): We enhanced security recommendations by adding guidance about phishing-resistant multifactor authentication (MFA) to protect against credential-based attacks. We also clarified the principle of just-enough access

with just-in-time (JIT) enforcement and expanded role assignment examples to show separate production and dev/test environments. We updated terminology to reflect the retirement of classic Azure administrators.

- [Identity and access management design area](#): We enhanced the introduction to emphasize the foundational role of identity in cloud security and added warnings about the risks of poorly secured identity. We clarified team responsibilities by distinguishing between platform identity teams and application administrators. We improved terminology to better reflect current best practices for Zero Trust and identity architecture.
- [What is an Azure landing zone?](#): We clarified terminology and improved conceptual understanding. We enhanced the introduction to better explain Azure landing zones as the standardized approach for all organizations that use Azure. We also clarified the distinction between platform landing zones (shared services) and application landing zones (workload hosting), and improved descriptions throughout the article for better consistency and accuracy.
- [Network topology and connectivity for Azure Arc-enabled servers](#): We updated this guidance to reflect current service capabilities and best practices. We clarified that Azure Arc gateway is now generally available, noted that indirectly connected mode is retired as of September 2025, and enhanced recommendations for Azure Private Link implementation, including Domain Name System (DNS) considerations and Azure ExpressRoute resiliency practices.
- [Azure App Service application landing zone accelerator](#): We aligned this article with current terminology and framework guidance. We changed the title and references to *application landing zone accelerator* to clarify that this accelerator deploys workloads into application landing zones rather than creating the underlying Azure landing zone platform. We also improved clarity throughout the article about the accelerator's role in App Service deployments.
- [Azure Integration Services application landing zone accelerator in an Azure landing zone](#): We aligned this article with current Cloud Adoption Framework terminology and guidance. We changed the title and references to *application landing zone accelerator* to clarify that this accelerator deploys workloads into application landing zones rather than creating the underlying platform. We also restructured the content to emphasize the importance of starting with an established Azure landing zone and improved guidance about using the accelerator within existing enterprise environments.

- [Azure Virtual Desktop network topology and connectivity design guidance](#): We clarified technical guidance for implementing Virtual Desktop within Azure landing zones. We reorganized the content into distinct sections that cover networking components, recommendations, and detailed scenarios. We also enhanced architectural guidance for different deployment patterns and improved clarity for Remote Desktop Protocol (RDP) Shortpath implementation and DNS configuration requirements.
- [Virtual WAN network topology in an Azure landing zone](#): We clarified implementation steps for Azure landing zones. We reorganized the content into distinct sections that cover hub-and-spoke architecture creation, deployment planning, connectivity options, routing configuration, security controls, and monitoring practices. We enhanced the article with updated diagrams, improved accessibility descriptions, and simplified the migration guidance to focus on essential steps for implementing Virtual WAN within enterprise environments.

September 2025

New articles

- [Azure Arc Connectivity Design for Oracle Exadata Database@Azure](#): Learn how to securely connect Oracle Exadata Database@Azure to Azure Arc by planning strategy, preserving existing network security, configuring outbound connectivity, integrating security tools, enforcing compliance, and validating your setup.
- [Oracle Autonomous Database@Azure Business Continuity and Disaster Recovery Guide](#): Learn about business continuity and disaster recovery (BCDR) for Oracle Autonomous Database@Azure, including how to set recovery goals, use high availability and backup strategies, enable seamless failover for applications, and test recovery procedures.

Updated articles

- [Create your AI strategy](#): We added a new section that explains why structured planning matters. We added detailed guidance about how to identify high-impact AI use cases, select service models, and develop responsible AI and data strategies. We also added a table of Azure tools and resources to support implementation.
- [Microsoft Cloud Adoption Framework for Azure](#): We updated the introduction to position the framework as the authoritative Azure adoption blueprint, streamlined problem and audience value messaging, and expanded scenarios to map challenges to ideal use cases.

We also added concise key takeaways that summarize return on investment (ROI), risk reduction, scalability, industry breadth, and continuous value.

- [Enterprise-scale support for Azure Virtual Desktop](#): We refocused the article around an action-oriented flow. The flow includes the foundation (landing zone), deployment (accelerator), expansion (capacity or proximity), then optimization (design areas and tools). We also condensed regional guidance and added a compact tools table.
- [Identity and access management for Azure Arc-enabled servers](#): We revised the guidance to focus on practical steps for securing identities and access. We added diagrams, checklists, and tips for managed identities, role-based access, and service principals. We also expanded resource links and next steps for easier navigation.
- [Connectivity to Oracle Cloud Infrastructure](#): We turned a bullet list into a phased, action-first guide for Azure and Oracle Cloud Infrastructure (OCI) connectivity. We added clear sections, numbered steps with rationale, FastPath and availability zone guidance, operational access options, and cost and governance cues. We also consolidated links into a tools table, improved visuals, and merged prior recommendations into outcome-driven instructions.
- [Connectivity to other cloud providers](#): We changed a considerations list into a prescriptive, sectioned guide that helps you choose and implement the right cross-cloud connectivity pattern fast. We added clear option evaluation, numbered steps for planning, FastPath performance guidance, and implementation and optimization patterns. We consolidated links into a concise tools table and upgraded diagrams with accessible, descriptive context.
- [Azure landing zone design principles](#): We expanded subscription democratization into clear numbered actions. We also strengthened policy-driven governance by tying Azure Policy to security, compliance, and safe self-service.
- [Azure application landing zone accelerators](#): We clarified how application landing zones build on the Azure environment, updated guidance about subscriptions and required services, and streamlined information about accelerators. We also updated the introduction to focus on Azure application landing zone accelerators and added direct links to accelerator resources.
- [Hybrid and multicloud adoption with Azure Arc and Azure landing zones](#): We updated the article to focus on unified hybrid and multicloud adoption with Azure Arc and Azure landing zones. We reorganized and clarified the guidance, added new examples and diagrams to show how on-premises, multicloud, and edge resources can be projected into Azure for centralized management, and replaced detailed tables with streamlined, actionable steps.

- [Use infrastructure as code to deploy and manage your Azure environment](#): We focused on using infrastructure as code (IaC) for Azure, explained when to use Bicep or Terraform, and gave quick tips for designing and sharing modules. We also added guidance about how to automate deployments with pipelines.
- [Assess cloud risks](#): We revised the article to clarify the cloud risk assessment process. Key sections are now numbered, guidance is expanded, and the risk register is presented in a table for better readability. We also improved details about risk categories and analysis.
- [Build a cloud governance team](#): We rewrote the introduction and major sections to clarify cloud governance as an ongoing process with defined functions, team selection, authority, and scope, including a new emphasis on RACI matrices and cross-functional roles. We also updated diagrams, added quick links, and replaced outdated content.
- [Document cloud governance policies](#): We made the guidance clearer and more actionable. We also restructured the content into four numbered steps with best practices, switched the diagram image format, and replaced bullets with concise, numbered lists for each recommendation.
- [Enforce cloud governance policies](#): We clarified that enforcement is a shared responsibility, emphasizing automation wherever feasible and manual processes only when needed. We reorganized and simplified the guidance, added clearer numbering to key sections, and updated references to Azure tools and best practices.
- [Monitor cloud compliance](#): We revised the article to focus on monitoring cloud compliance rather than cloud governance, updated section headings for clarity, and reorganized recommendations into clearly numbered steps.
- [Unified hybrid and multicloud operations](#): We revised the strategy guidance to position Azure as the unified control plane for hybrid and multicloud environments. The update introduces a prescriptive framework for aligning business drivers, vision, metrics, principles, and technology mapping, with detailed recommendations about how to use Azure Arc, Azure Monitor, Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS), Microsoft Fabric, Azure IoT, Azure Local, Microsoft Defender for Cloud, and Microsoft Entra ID for unified management and modernization.
- [Prepare your organization for the cloud](#): We updated the article to focus on cloud operating models instead of just cloud management. We clarified the definitions and responsibilities for centralized, shared management, decentralized, and hybrid models. We also improved the table to better reflect platform landing zones and updated examples for different organization types.
- [Identity and access management for Oracle Database@Azure](#): We refocused the guidance on federated identity, role-based access control (RBAC), Azure Arc integration, and enhanced security with Microsoft Defender. We clarified deployment steps and

automated group management, and we added new sections for hybrid and security best practices.

- [Manage and monitor Oracle Database@Azure](#): We expanded and restructured the guidance, adding detailed instructions about multilayer monitoring, security integration, and Log Analytics workspace strategy. We clarified best practices, updated stakeholders, and provided new tables and references for metrics, tools, and resources.
- [Network topology and connectivity for Oracle Database@Azure - Get started](#): We provided a clearer, sequential approach for designing network connectivity, emphasizing foundational steps before advanced scenarios. We added guidance about how to configure network security groups (NSGs), coordinate Azure and OCI rules. Finally, we summarized the key design areas in a new implementation sequence table.
- [Platform automation and DevOps for Oracle Exadata Database@Azure](#): We enhanced guidance for deploying Oracle Exadata Database@Azure by using IaC. We added details about Azure Arc integration, new Azure Verified Modules for monitoring and governance, and extra sections on security, diagnostics, and hybrid management considerations. We also clarified next steps and related resources for streamlined deployments.
- [Security for Oracle Database@Azure](#): We expanded and restructured the article to emphasize defense-in-depth, Azure Arc integration, and Microsoft Defender for Cloud. We added detailed recommendations for dual-platform governance, network security, encryption, key management, and operational isolation. Finally, we provided more links to relevant Oracle and Microsoft documentation.
- [BCDR for Oracle Database@Azure by using Exadata Database service](#): We updated the article to focus on Oracle Exadata Database@Azure, clarified disaster recovery concepts, and added references to Oracle Maximum Availability Architecture (MAA). We improved explanations of backup options, updated links, and included more details about recovery time objective (RTO), recovery point objective (RPO), and service-level agreements (SLAs).
- [AKS landing zone accelerator](#): We clarified the overview and guidance. We also edited the architecture diagram and description, revised section titles, and removed redundant conceptual and resource sections for better readability.
- [Network connectivity for Azure Arc-enabled SQL Managed Instance](#): We updated the documentation to reflect that, as of September 2025, indirectly connected mode for Azure Arc-enabled data services is retired and only directly connected mode is supported. We clarified that connectivity to Azure is required and recommended that organizations verify business requirements and environment compatibility with directly connected mode. We also improved language around network connectivity considerations and deployment recommendations.

- [Management and monitoring for Azure Arc-enabled servers](#): We replaced references to *Log Analytics agent* with *Azure Monitor agent*, and we updated the related documentation links.
- [Prepare workloads for cloud migration to Azure](#): We clarified instructions and improved step-by-step details in several sections. We emphasized validating environments and expanded recommendations for network connectivity, authentication, and performance testing.
- [Secure overview](#): We provided clearer, more actionable guidance for applying the Cloud Adoption Framework Secure methodology across every phase of cloud adoption. We modernized the language; emphasized continuous security posture improvement, incident response, and the CIA Triad; and streamlined the cloud security checklist for easier navigation and tracking.
- [Define your naming convention](#): We streamlined content, updated examples, and removed outdated sections to help teams easily adopt effective naming practices.
- [Security considerations for the Azure Integration Services landing zone accelerator](#): We updated terminology for clarity, added links to relevant Azure documentation, and improved guidance about key security practices, such as encryption, managed identities, and deployment automation. We also refined our recommendations to ensure that we use the most secure and current Azure services and features.
- [Network topology and connectivity considerations for the Azure Integration Services landing zone accelerator](#): We improved clarity and consistency, added more Azure service links, and refined several technical terms and explanations for network topology and connectivity in Azure Integration Services. We also reorganized recommendations, enhanced guidance for private endpoints, and expanded details about Domain Name System (DNS), App Service Environment, and service-specific networking designs.
- [Governance considerations for the Azure Integration Services landing zone accelerator](#): We clarified the governance definition and updated automation recommendations to include GitHub Actions, the Azure Pipelines service in Azure DevOps, Bicep, and Terraform. We also added disaster recovery resource links for Logic Apps, Function Apps, and Data Factory.
- [Identity and access management considerations for the Azure Integration Services landing zone accelerator](#): We updated the article for clarity and added direct links to Microsoft documentation. We also improved terminology and references to help guide identity and access management decisions for Azure Integration Services.

August 2025

New articles

- [Capacity planning for Oracle Autonomous Database@Azure](#): Learn about planning compute, storage, and autoscaling to optimize performance and cost for Oracle Autonomous Database@Azure. Independently scale compute and storage, schedule noncritical downtime, and enable storage and compute autoscaling for variable workloads. Align capacity decisions with workload patterns and disaster recovery requirements, including Autonomous Data Guard parity.
- [Capacity planning for Oracle Database@Azure by using Exadata Database Service](#): Learn about planning network, delegated subnets, and Exadata infrastructure sizing for Oracle Database@Azure by using Exadata. Optimize capacity by using independent scaling, online expansion, symmetric virtual machine cluster adjustments, and cost controls like scaling to zero. Make early storage and backup layout choices that support resilience, external backups, and future growth without rework.
- [Set up identity in Azure](#): Learn how to establish a secure identity foundation in Azure by creating individual user accounts, assigning least-privilege roles, and enforcing multifactor authentication (MFA). Apply built-in roles with just-in-time (JIT) elevation via Microsoft Entra Privileged Identity Management (PIM) and restrict Global Administrator use. Use security defaults or Conditional Access policies to balance protection and flexibility.

Updated articles

- [Manage access to resources in Azure](#): We restructured this article around three actions: apply least privilege, use Microsoft Entra ID groups instead of individual assignments, and run regular access reviews. We added prescriptive tables and steps, and explicit Owner role limits. We removed duplicated portal walkthroughs, zone variants, and passive introductory text.
- [Create your AI strategy](#): We surfaced the decision tree earlier to guide service model choices up front. We split Microsoft Copilot consumption from low-code agent building for clearer paths. We streamlined wording in tables and headings for faster scanning.
- [Select Azure regions](#): We updated our region selection guidance to make it clearer and more actionable. We simplified steps to check data residency and compliance, choose regions close to users to reduce latency, and validate service availability, pricing, zones, pairs, and capacity. We simplified language and tables to map each scenario directly to an action. We clarified that paired regions are optional and updated multi-region guidance.
- [Execute migration to the cloud](#): We added new guidance to help organizations migrate from Azure Analysis Services, Azure Synapse Analytics, and non-Microsoft business

intelligence (BI) tools to Power BI and Microsoft Fabric. These updates streamline data and analytics transitions, provide step-by-step support for moving assets like pipelines and notebooks, and provide strategic planning resources to accelerate adoption and unlock the full value of the Microsoft unified data platform.

- [Organize Oracle Database@Azure resources for consistent deployments](#): We added prescriptive naming and tagging guidance with Oracle-specific constraints and examples. We expanded security and isolation into clear actions, such as environment Azure role-based access control (RBAC), network segmentation, monitoring, and Microsoft Sentinel integration. To reduce operational risk, we formalized multi-subscription architecture, such as onboarding permissions, provider registration, billing consolidation, zone mapping, and Exadata sharing. We centralized tooling in a resources table so that teams can implement faster.
- [Prepare workloads for the cloud](#): We streamlined how organizations prepare workloads for Azure migration. We renamed and restructured sections for clarity, consolidated deployment steps, and aligned instructions with real-world practices. These changes make the content easier to follow and more actionable for cloud migrations.
- [Capacity planning for migrating Oracle workloads to Azure Virtual Machines](#): We improved clarity and alignment with current Azure best practices for migrating Oracle workloads. We simplified language throughout and reorganized guidance for storage planning. We also improved explanations for Automatic Workload Repository (AWR) reports, VM sizing, and disk configurations to help teams make informed decisions during migration.

July 2025

Updated methodologies

- CAF Plan:
 1. [Prepare your organization for the cloud](#): Learn how to prepare your organization for successful Azure cloud adoption by choosing and implementing appropriate cloud operations models that distribute responsibilities across governance, security, and operations teams. Discover guidance for how to select centralized, shared management, or decentralized approaches based on organizational size, maturity, and business requirements to ensure strategic alignment and operational effectiveness.
 2. [Prepare your people for the cloud](#): Learn how to equip your team with essential Azure skills through targeted training, expert support, and continuous learning

programs to accelerate cloud adoption success and reduce implementation risks.

Discover systematic approaches for how to assess skill gaps across Azure fundamentals, environment management, and cloud-native development while you establish sustainable learning cultures that maximize your cloud investment returns.

3. Plan migration (if applicable)

- [Discover your existing workload inventory](#): Learn how to create a comprehensive workload inventory and prioritize assets for successful Azure cloud migration by using automated discovery tools and business value frameworks. Discover systematic approaches for identifying existing infrastructure, applications, and dependencies across all environments while gathering crucial business requirements to guide your cloud adoption strategy.
- [Select your cloud migration strategies](#): Learn how to select cloud migration strategies for your workloads by using the "8 Rs" framework (Retire, Retain, Rehost, Replatform, Refactor, Rearchitect, Rebuild, Replace). This guide helps you align business drivers with appropriate migration approaches, from decommissioning obsolete systems to building cloud-native solutions. Discover when to modernize during migration, how to communicate decisions effectively, and establish success metrics that validate business outcomes for each strategy.
- [Assess your workloads for cloud migration](#): Learn about conducting thorough workload assessments for Azure migration. This guide covers architecture analysis, performance metrics collection, dependency mapping, and compliance validation. Discover automated assessment tools like Azure Migrate and AppCAT, risk management strategies, and systematic approaches to evaluate application code compatibility and database dependencies for successful migration planning.

4. Plan your Azure environment for cost estimation

Learn how to create accurate Azure cost estimates by planning architectures, selecting appropriate services and tiers, and defining regional deployment strategies for your cloud environment. Discover systematic approaches for documenting architectural decisions, using cost estimation tools, validating assumptions through test deployments, and establishing cost baselines to support effective financial planning and governance.

- [Template: Cloud adoption plan template for cloud-native startups](#): Learn how to create a comprehensive cloud adoption plan for Azure-native startups by documenting operation models, training strategies, landing zone architecture, and workload requirements to accelerate your cloud journey. Use structured templates that cover responsibility assignments, continuous learning programs, resource hierarchy plans, and technical specifications to ensure successful cloud-native business development.

- [Template: Cloud adoption plan template for migration](#): Learn how to create a comprehensive cloud adoption plan template for Azure migration by documenting your operation model, training strategies, platform architecture, and detailed workload requirements. Use structured frameworks to capture business and technical details, define responsibilities, plan Azure landing zone components, and establish success metrics for a successful cloud migration.
- [Guide: Shared management cloud operations](#): Learn how to implement a shared management cloud operations model that scales Azure adoption through platform engineering by building reusable platform capabilities and establishing clear team responsibilities. Discover systematic approaches for creating modular platform services, enabling self-service infrastructure, coordinating multiple specialized teams, and applying product management practices to accelerate workload delivery across enterprise environments.
- CAF Migrate:
 1. [Plan your migration](#): Learn how to create comprehensive migration plans that define workload sequences, data transfer paths, and rollback strategies for successful Azure cloud migrations. Explore detailed guidance for migration readiness assessment, dependency management, stakeholder engagement, and how to choose appropriate migration methods to ensure secure and efficient cloud adoption process.
 2. [Prepare workloads for the cloud](#): Learn how to prepare workloads for successful Azure cloud migration by validating compatibility, resolving infrastructure problems, and conducting comprehensive tests in Azure environments. Explore step-by-step guidance for how to fix compatibility problems, validate network connectivity and authentication flows, performance tests, and create reusable infrastructure templates to ensure reliable cloud adoption.
 3. [Execute migration to the cloud](#): Learn how to implement successful Azure cloud migration with structured guidance for both near-zero downtime and planned downtime approaches, which includes stakeholder preparation, environment setup, and data migration validation. Explore comprehensive migration implementation strategies that cover database replication, cutover procedures, fallback options, and post-migration support to ensure business continuity throughout your cloud migration process.
 4. [Optimize workloads after migration](#): Learn how to optimize workloads after Azure migration through performance fine-tuning, cost management, monitoring validation, and backup verification to ensure efficient cloud operations. Explore

comprehensive post-migration strategies that include user feedback collection, hybrid dependency management, and regular architecture reviews to maximize your cloud investment and operational excellence.

5. [Decommission source workloads after migration to the cloud](#): Learn how to safely decommission source workloads after successful Azure cloud migration by obtaining stakeholder approval, optimizing software licenses, and preserving data for compliance requirements. Explore step-by-step guidance about how to reduce operational costs, ensure regulatory compliance, and update documentation to complete your cloud migration life cycle.
- [Guide: Migration wave planning](#): Learn how to organize workloads into structured migration waves for successful Azure cloud adoption by using an iterative approach that reduces risk and complexity while you build team experience. Explore comprehensive guidance for dependency management, workload prioritization frameworks, timeline plans, and wave implementation strategies to accelerate your cloud migration journey.
- CAF Modernize:
 1. [Prepare for cloud modernization](#): Learn how to prepare your organization for successful cloud modernization by defining modernization scope, assessing team skills and readiness gaps, and establishing cross-functional collaboration frameworks. Explore structured approaches to prioritize workloads by using business value and technical risk assessment matrices.
 2. [Plan your cloud modernization](#): Learn how to plan cloud modernization projects through structured approaches for choosing appropriate modernization strategies, establishing phased implementation timelines with governance frameworks, and implementing deployment strategies with comprehensive risk mitigation and stakeholder approval processes.
 3. [Execute modernizations in the cloud](#): Learn how to implement cloud modernization projects through stakeholder preparation, controlled development, comprehensive tests, and safe deployment strategies. This article covers how to develop modernizations in nonproduction environments, conduct thorough validation that includes performance and security tests, and deploy by using in-place or parallel approaches with progressive traffic routing and post-deployment stabilization.
 4. [Optimize workloads after cloud modernization](#): Learn about optimizing Azure workloads after cloud modernization to maximize benefits and establish continuous improvement practices. This guide covers validating configurations by using Azure

Advisor, establishing operational readiness through monitoring and cost controls, testing backup and recovery procedures, and measuring actual outcomes against modernization goals. Discover how to implement systematic feedback collection, automate optimization processes, and create ongoing modernization cycles to prevent legacy system drift and ensure long-term cloud success.

- [Guide: Modernization guidance to replatform, refactor, and rearchitect](#): Explore modernization guidance for cloud workloads by using three core strategies: replatform to move components to Azure PaaS services with minimal code changes, refactor application code for improved performance and cloud optimization, and rearchitect to redesign architecture for enhanced scalability and cloud-native capabilities. The guide provides categorized resources and architectural patterns for each modernization approach.
- CAF Cloud-native:
 - [Plan cloud-native solutions](#): Learn how to plan cloud-native Azure solutions through strategic business alignment, architectural design, and deployment preparation. This article covers how to define measurable business objectives and requirements, explore validated architecture patterns and Azure service selection, plan integrations with existing systems, and establish deployment strategies that include progressive exposure and rollback procedures to ensure successful delivery of new workloads or features.
 - [Build cloud-native solutions](#): Learn how to build resilient cloud-native Azure solutions by using best practices for development, testing, CI/CD, and monitoring to create production-ready applications at scale. Explore guidance about how to apply Well-Architected Framework principles, implement comprehensive test strategies that include load tests with Azure Load Testing, and integrate Azure Monitor and Application Insights for observability.
 - [Deploy cloud-native solutions](#): Learn how to deploy cloud-native solutions to Azure with comprehensive strategies for stakeholder preparation, CI/CD pipeline implementation, progressive rollout techniques, and post-deployment validation to ensure successful production deployments.
 - [Optimize cloud-native solutions after deployment](#): Learn how to optimize Azure cloud-native solutions after deployment through service configuration tuning, operational validation, and continuous improvement practices. This article covers how to apply Azure Advisor recommendations, establish monitoring and cost controls, test backup procedures, and collect user feedback to ensure that solutions remain secure, cost-effective, and performant.

New articles

- [Platform automation and DevOps for Oracle Exadata Database@Azure](#): Learn how to deploy Oracle Exadata Database@Azure infrastructure by using infrastructure as code and Azure Verified Modules for reliable and consistent automation across your Azure environments. Discover comprehensive guidance for how to use Terraform providers, handle idempotency challenges, configure Oracle components with OCI Terraform, and implement standardized deployment patterns that follow Azure best practices for reliability and security.

Updated articles

- [Optimize workloads after cloud modernization](#): We updated links in the **Next steps** section that describe how to govern, secure, and manage Azure.
- [What is Microsoft Cloud Adoption Framework for Azure?](#): We updated the Cloud Adoption Framework overview to improve clarity and organization. The **Why use the Cloud Adoption Framework?** section was streamlined into a single paragraph. The **Who should use the Cloud Adoption Framework?** section was restructured from a bullet list format into a table format. In the **How to use the Cloud Adoption Framework?** section, we clarified the methodology terminology by changing **Sequential methodologies** to **Foundational methodologies** and **Continuous methodologies** to **Operational methodologies**, and updated the explanatory text to better describe how these methodologies work together throughout the Azure adoption journey.
- [Assess your workloads for cloud migration](#): We restructured this guidance with numbered procedures for workload assessment, dependency mapping, and risk management. We also consolidated architectural documentation and separated unsupported technology identification into its own section with automated tool recommendations.
- [Document your cloud adoption plan](#): We updated the plan alignment guidance into clear subsections that have numbered steps. It expands the template selection guidance to include customization recommendations, breaks organizational standards alignment into separate mapping and compliance incorporation steps, and enhances the accountability documentation section with specific requirements for progress tracking, responsibility assignment, and stakeholder approval capture.
- [Select your cloud migration strategies](#): We added a section about engaging workload teams to validate business drivers and migration strategies. It emphasizes early collaboration to ensure that migration plans align with technical realities and business priorities through communication, documentation requests, strategy validation, team support, and executive sponsorship.

- [Management groups](#): We updated the management group design guidance to clarify RBAC assignment best practices, reorganize workload structuring recommendations, simplify the architecture section, and remove the permissions guidance for the Azure landing zone accelerator.
- [Tailor the Azure landing zone architecture](#): We updated this guidance to reflect that the Security management group is now part of the default Azure landing zone architecture, updated color references in the application landing zone section, and improved diagram accessibility.
- [Understand cloud operations functions](#): We restructured the content organization with clearer headings, added a comprehensive deliverables table, expanded the team preparation section, and included an Azure tools reference table.
- [Align responsibilities across teams](#): We simplified the RACI matrix tables by removing the capability alignment rows and streamlining the table formatting for better readability.
- [Plan for Azure VMware Solution](#): We updated this guidance to improve clarity and accessibility, including restructuring adoption stages with clearer formatting and enhancing technical requirements descriptions.
- [Business continuity and disaster recovery for Oracle Database@Azure by using Exadata Database Service](#): We updated this backup configuration guidance to include the ARS long-term backup feature by using OCI object storage and improved the storage backup recommendations structure.
- [Use the Azure Kubernetes Services \(AKS\) landing zone accelerator to deploy scalable AKS clusters](#): We restructured this guidance with numbered procedures for deploying AKS clusters, enhanced the platform foundation requirements, and added an Azure tools and resources reference table.
- [Govern AI](#): We restructured this article with numbered procedures for AI risk assessment and governance, enhanced the enforcement and monitoring sections, and improved clarity throughout this article.
- [Manage AI](#): We restructured this guidance with numbered procedures for AI operations management, expanded the business continuity section with specific backup and recovery strategies, and enhanced the data management recommendations.
- [Plan for AI adoption](#): We restructured this article with actionable numbered procedures for AI skills assessment, capability development, resource access planning, and proof-of-concept validation to help you create comprehensive AI adoption plans.
- [Get AI architecture guidance for Azure platform services \(PaaS\) for AI](#): We restructured this guidance with numbered procedures for selecting appropriate AI architectures, implementing operational frameworks, and adopting AI standards for both generative and nongenerative workloads by using Azure PaaS solutions.

- [Govern Azure platform services \(PaaS\) for AI](#): We restructured this guidance with numbered procedures for governing AI platforms, models, costs, security, operations, regulatory compliance, and data by using Azure PaaS solutions to ensure responsible AI practices and organizational alignment.
- [Manage Azure platform services \(PaaS\) for AI](#): We enhanced this guidance with structured numbered procedures for AI deployment strategies, comprehensive model monitoring approaches, and operational best practices to ensure effective management of Azure AI platform services.
- [Configure secure networking for Azure AI platform services](#): We organized the content with numbered procedures for virtual network configuration, connectivity management, and security implementation strategies to protect AI resources and ensure data integrity across Azure AI platform services.
- [Select Azure platform services \(PaaS\) for AI](#): We restructured this guidance with numbered procedures for choosing appropriate Azure AI platforms, compute resources, and data processing tools to support both generative and nongenerative AI applications effectively.
- [Secure Azure platform services \(PaaS\) for AI](#): We restructured content with numbered procedures and added a new **Secure AI data** section that covers data boundaries and RBAC.
- [AI ready](#): We reorganized the content from four sections to three focused areas and added numbered procedures for governance boundaries, secure connectivity, and AI reliability across regions.
- [Secure AI](#): We restructured content with numbered procedures and added a new **Secure AI data** section that covers data boundaries and RBAC.
- [AI strategy](#): We added guidance about AI agents and Model Context Protocol (MCP) for interoperability, enhanced the AI decision tree diagram, and included a comprehensive example AI strategy table that demonstrates how to apply AI approaches across different use cases, from e-commerce to regulated industries.
- [Azure landing zone frequently asked questions \(FAQ\)](#): We added a new **FAQ** section that clarifies that you can use the existing Azure landing zone architecture to deploy AI workloads without requiring a separate AI landing zone.
- [What is an Azure landing zone?](#): We added a new section about AI in Azure landing zones, moved the application landing zone accelerators section to appear earlier in this article, and added a reference to the FAQ in the **Next steps** section.

June 2025

Updated articles

- [Network topology and connectivity for Oracle Database@Azure - BCDR connectivity design](#): We replaced multiple complex topology options with a single, focused recommendation for global virtual network peering for cross-region connectivity. We also clarified cost terminology and streamlined the design considerations.
- [Network topology and connectivity for Oracle Database@Azure - Core network design](#): We clarified patching processes, provided clearer network security group management recommendations, and added guidance about the five Oracle-delegated subnet limit for each region.
- [Network topology and connectivity for Oracle Database@Azure - Migration connectivity design](#): We made updates to improve clarity and accuracy and refined the guidance about capacity planning and connectivity effects in the design considerations and recommendations sections.
- [Create and scale Azure subscriptions](#): We added comprehensive subscription life cycle management guidance that includes new sections about subscription policies, governance, scaling strategies with automation and templates, and ongoing monitoring.
- [Define your naming convention](#): We made significant structural and content updates to explain the importance of naming conventions and understanding Azure resource names.
- [Define your tagging strategy](#): We added a comprehensive resource tagging approach that includes new sections about how to define tagging requirements, implement consistent tagging by using Azure policies and security considerations, and apply foundational tagging categories.
- [Organize your Azure resources effectively](#): We reorganized the content and added links to best practices for resource tagging strategies and organization.
- [Deploy Azure App Service at scale with landing zone accelerator](#): We added more detailed, process-oriented guidance and step-by-step recommendations for flexible implementation and customization. We also added a new architecture diagram that shows Azure Front Door and App Service Environment v3 integration.
- [Microsoft Cloud Adoption Framework for Azure](#): We streamlined this article to focus on why you should use the framework, who should use the framework, and how to use the framework. We also added a new section on cloud adoption scenarios.
- [Capacity planning for Oracle workloads on Azure Virtual Machines](#): We made changes to reflect the latest Azure capabilities and best practices for Oracle workload capacity planning, with specific emphasis on newer virtual machine (VM) series and storage technologies.

- [Select Azure regions](#): We updated the Azure region selection section with clearer decision-making criteria and reliability, capability, and cost considerations.
- [Azure setup guide overview](#): We removed Azure portal integration and interactive elements and replaced the checklist format with a comprehensive table that describes each step in the Azure setup guide.
- [AI strategy](#): We provided a more comprehensive and strategic approach to AI adoption by adding clearer implementation steps and enhanced guidance for data strategy and responsible AI practices.
- [Identity and access management recommendations for Azure Virtual Desktop](#): We added more comprehensive, actionable guidance for implementing identity and access management, including a new section for single sign-on and updated design considerations.
- [Storage considerations for AKS](#): We made updates to streamline the content and improve technical accuracy. We also added sections for Azure Container Storage.
- [Enterprise-scale support for Citrix on Azure](#): We reorganized the content in this article and made minor edits.
- [Establish an AI Center of Excellence](#): We added specific steps, detailed role definitions, organizational integration recommendations, and maturity-based operational evolution to provide a more strategic approach to establishing and operating an AI Center of Excellence.
- [Select Azure platform as a service \(PaaS\) solutions for AI](#): We updated resource recommendations to include Foundry Agent Service and streamlined the guidance to present Foundry as the comprehensive solution and Azure OpenAI for specific model access needs.

May 2025

Updated articles

- [Prepare for cloud adoption](#): We refined the Azure Landing Zones concepts section to provide a more detailed summary of designing and deploying landing zones.
- [Abbreviation recommendations for Azure resources](#): We updated abbreviations for Foundry and Foundry project with the updates to the resource provider.

Defense scenario retirement

We retired the articles that formerly made up the defense scenario. The content was outdated and no longer relevant to the Cloud Adoption Framework.

April 2025

Updated articles

- [Administer your Azure cloud estate](#): We added guidance on managing workload relocations, including drivers, risks, costs, and projects.
- [Manage AI – Process to manage AI](#): We made updates to the "AI endpoint sharing" section, now the "AI resource sharing" section.
- [Management recommendations for AI workloads on Azure](#): We added guidance for managing AI deployments, including finding the best region, using AI hubs, and managing multiple deployments.
- [Protect your Azure cloud estate](#): We made updates for clarity and refreshed the content to reflect the latest Azure services and best practices for protecting your cloud estate.
- [Ready your Azure cloud operations](#): We made significant updates for clarity and accuracy.
- [Testing approach for Azure landing zones](#): We made significant updates to Azure Landing Zone canary guidance to improve the clarity and usability of the content based on customer feedback.
- [What is an Azure landing zone?](#): We added a conceptual architecture diagram to differentiate between platform and application landing zones.

March 2025

Manage methodology refresh

This month, we made significant updates to the Manage methodology. The Manage methodology provides guidance on how to manage your cloud environment and optimize your cloud operations. Some highlights of our updates to the methodology include:

- [Ready your Azure cloud operations](#): Learn how to prepare your Azure cloud operations for success. Learn how to establish defined responsibilities and processes for every cloud management area.
- [Administer your Azure cloud estate](#): Explore new guidance on managing resource sprawl and detailed steps to implement governance policies, organize resources, restrict deployment permissions, and conduct regular audits.
- [Monitor your Azure cloud estate](#): Find new guidance on how to monitor various aspects of your cloud estate, like service health, security, compliance, costs, data, code, and cloud resources. We also made updates to reflect new terms and resources.

- [Protect your Azure cloud estate](#): Learn best practices for ensuring the reliability and security of Azure cloud operations, including how to maintain minimal downtime and establish robust security measures. Key sections include managing reliability through redundancy, replication, and recovery strategies, defining reliability requirements, and prioritizing workloads based on business impact.

Updated articles

- [AI Plan - Process to plan for AI adoption](#): We made adjustments to the AI maturity level table, and modifications to various sections such as "Acquire AI skills," "Access AI resources," "Prioritize AI use cases," and "Create an AI proof of concept."
- [AI Strategy - Process to develop an AI strategy](#): We reorganized and streamlined the AI technology strategy, extensibility tools for Microsoft 365 Copilot, and responsible AI strategy sections. New content was added to highlight the use of Microsoft Fabric and Azure services in various AI applications.
- [Secure AI – Process to secure AI](#): We made minor updates to align this article with the NIST Cybersecurity Framework and the Microsoft Security Reference Architecture.

February 2025

New articles

- [Network topology and connectivity for Oracle Database@Azure - Application connectivity design](#): Learn how to establish direct connectivity between database and application VMs in Oracle IaaS environments. Explore the importance of secure and efficient network configurations to ensure seamless communication and optimal performance.
- [Network topology and connectivity for Oracle Database@Azure - BCDR connectivity design](#): Explore comprehensive guidance on designing network connectivity for high availability and disaster recovery of Oracle Exadata Database@Azure deployments. Learn about redundancy strategies both within a single region and across multiple regions, emphasizing the use of Azure and OCI networking, availability zones, and Data Guard configurations.
- [Network topology and connectivity for Oracle Database@Azure - Core network design](#): Find essential guidance on designing the core network for Oracle Exadata Database@Azure, including key networking concepts, like the unique architecture of Oracle Database@Azure, and design considerations such as availability zone selection, subnet sizing, and network security group configuration.

- [Network topology and connectivity for Oracle Database@Azure - Migration connectivity design](#): Learn how to design connectivity solutions for Oracle Infrastructure as a Service (IaaS) migration scenarios. Explore best practices for ensuring secure, reliable, and efficient network architectures to facilitate the migration process.
- [Resource organization for Oracle Database@Azure](#): Learn best practices for naming and tagging conventions, security and isolation architectures, and subscription design. Explore how to use a multiple subscription architecture to isolate different environments such as production, development, and testing.

Updated articles

- [Inventory and visibility considerations](#): We added information on application teams and their responsibilities for inventory and visibility, including the use of Azure Monitor Agent and Log Analytics workspaces.
- [Management and monitoring for Azure VMware Solution](#): We added references to Azure Monitor baselines alerts (AMBA).
- [Plan for inbound and outbound internet connectivity](#): We made updates to include guidance on ensuring that Management NIC is enabled with all Azure Firewall deployments.
- [Resource organization considerations for Azure Virtual Desktop](#): We added guidance on naming and tagging standards and introduced sections on the scope of management settings, components, naming standards, and resource tags.

We made updates to these articles to reflect the latest guidance on migrating to virtual network flow logs due to the upcoming retirement of NSG flow logs:

- [Plan for landing zone network segmentation](#)
- [Plan for traffic inspection](#)

Oracle updates

- [Manage and monitor Oracle workloads on Azure Virtual Machines landing zone accelerator](#): We made updates to refresh the content and improve clarity. This article provides guidance on managing and monitoring Oracle workloads on Azure Virtual Machines, including best practices for performance optimization, security, and compliance.
- [Security guidelines for Oracle Database@Azure](#): We added detailed descriptions of the integration between Azure and Oracle Cloud Infrastructure (OCI) for managing Oracle Exadata Database@Azure resources. We also added design considerations such as: The

need for network security groups (NSGs) and network address translation (NAT) configurations; Guidelines for storing and managing encryption keys and database backups; Recommendations for the deployment and management of non-Microsoft and Oracle agents.

January 2025

New articles

- [Capacity Planning for Oracle Database@Azure Using Exadata Database Service](#): Learn how to plan for capacity when migrating Oracle Database to Azure using Exadata Database Service. Explore key considerations for capacity planning, including workload analysis, performance tuning, and resource allocation. Recommendations include planning for sufficient IP address ranges, scaling infrastructure based on workload requirements, and understanding storage configuration impacts.

Strategy methodology refresh

This month, we made significant updates to the Strategy methodology. The Strategy methodology provides guidance on how to develop a cloud adoption strategy that aligns with your organization's goals and objectives. The methodology includes the following articles:

- [Develop a cloud adoption strategy](#): Learn how to develop a cloud adoption strategy to migrate or innovate in the cloud, in alignment with your business goals.
- [Assess your cloud adoption strategy](#): Learn about the importance of assessing your cloud adoption strategy and how to evaluate your current state, define your future state, and identify gaps and opportunities.
- [Determine your motivations](#): Learn how to identify your motivations for adopting cloud technologies and how to classify them based on your organization's goals and objectives.
- [Define your strategy team](#): Learn about the key roles and responsibilities of a cloud strategy team and how to build a cross-functional team to drive your cloud adoption strategy.
- [Prepare your organization](#): Learn how to align your cloud adoption strategy with your organization's goals and objectives.
 - [Inform your cloud adoption strategy](#): Learn about the importance of informing your cloud adoption strategy and how to gather information, assess your current state, and define your future state.

- [Cost efficiency considerations](#): Learn about the importance of financial efficiency and how to optimize costs in your cloud adoption strategy.
- [AI considerations](#): Learn about considerations for integrating AI into your cloud adoption strategy. Use analytics, machine learning, and automation to optimize operations.
- [Resiliency considerations](#): Explore guidance on improving your infrastructure's ability to maintain functionality and availability despite disruptions or failures.
- [Security considerations](#): Learn how to design your cloud infrastructure with security in mind to protect your data and applications from unauthorized access and data breaches.
- [Sustainability considerations](#): Explore how to incorporate sustainability into your cloud strategy. Use Azure to drive your sustainability efforts.

Updated articles

- [Define your naming convention](#): We reviewed this article for freshness and accuracy, introducing more consistent terminology for workload, application, and project names. We also added guidance on the Azure Naming Tool and the importance of understanding naming rules and restrictions.
- [DNS for on-premises and Azure resources](#): Explore new design considerations and recommendations emphasizing the use of Azure DNS Private Resolver with Azure Private DNS zones and detailed guidance on deploying DNS infrastructure.
- [Governance disciplines for SAP on Azure](#): Explore new guidance for using Microsoft Defender for Endpoint on Linux and Windows for SAP hosts and new sections on the Microsoft Sentinel solution for SAP. We also added enhanced recommendations for secure authentication with Microsoft Entra ID and links to more detailed design considerations and identity management sections.
- [Identity and access management for SAP on Azure](#): Learn about securing Network File System (NFS) communication and Remote Function Call (RFC) connections, as well as SAP user governance and provisioning. Explore new recommendations for implementing single sign-on (SSO) with various SAP applications using Microsoft Entra ID.
- [Network topology and connectivity for Azure Arc-enabled servers](#): Explore new guidance on Azure Arc Gateway including instructions for defining agent connectivity methods.
- [Organize your Azure resources effectively](#): Find updated links for management group design, subscription considerations, and tagging strategy. Updates emphasize the importance of applying critical settings at higher levels and project-specific requirements

at lower levels, and include additional details on naming conventions and resource tagging to enhance resource identification and management.

- [Review product migration scenarios](#): Explore the new Google Cloud Platform scenario for migrating VMs to Azure.

AI Adoption updates

- [AI Governance for PaaS workloads](#): Learn how to control the models you allow across Azure and deployed in Foundry.
- [Secure AI](#): Learn how to conduct red team testing on generative AI and nongenerative AI models.

Oracle updates

- [Business continuity and disaster recovery considerations for Oracle Database@Azure](#): We added new design considerations and recommendations for multiple-zone and multiregional BCDR architectures, extended BCDR scenarios, backup recommendations, and introduced additional best practices for maintaining data resilience and automating failover operations.
- [Identity and access management for Oracle Database@Azure](#): Explore new sections covering considerations for private offers, default group creation, custom group names, federation with non-Microsoft identity providers, and enhanced RBAC permissions.
- [Migration Planning for Oracle on Azure](#): We introduced new sections on Oracle Database@Azure migration, online and offline migration paths, and an ExpressRoute-based migration duration reference table.

Azure Landing Zone updates

- [Deploy Azure landing zones by using Terraform](#): Explore new guidance on various network architectures, including multiple-region virtual WAN with Azure Firewall, multiple-region hub and spoke virtual network, and single-region virtual WAN with Azure Firewall. Explore how to use Azure Verified Modules for Platform Landing Zones Terraform for infrastructure as code deployments.
- [Migrate Azure landing zone custom policies to Azure built-in policies](#): Find refreshed migration guidance detailing the use of Azure Verified Modules for Platform Landing Zones, and updated references to Terraform and Bicep module resources.
- [What is an Azure landing zone](#): We updated guidance on the use of Bicep and Terraform for deploying platform landing zones and added a more detailed description of the Azure Platform Landing Zones Portal Accelerator.

ⓘ **Note:** The author created this article with assistance from AI. [Learn more](#)

Last updated on 04/09/2026

Develop a cloud adoption strategy

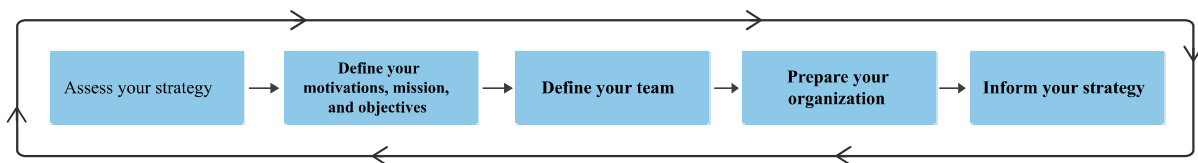


Summarize this article for me

A cloud adoption strategy is a comprehensive plan that outlines your organization's approach when you adopt and integrate cloud technologies.

To establish a cloud adoption strategy, understand your business needs and objectives to align cloud initiatives with business goals.

The journey to successfully maturing in the cloud, or to expanding your footprint, starts with the Cloud Adoption Framework Strategy methodology, which consists of the following five steps.



Organizations typically mature in iterations. Consider the Cloud Adoption Framework Strategy guide an iterative supplement to your cloud adoption strategy. Revisit the guide to reassess and iterate regularly.

Whether you're an existing cloud customer who wants to mature your cloud environment or you're new to the cloud, this guidance helps you establish a clear mission, goals, and measurable results. It also provides insights to inform your cloud investment decisions.

Why build a cloud adoption strategy?

Use a cloud adoption strategy to:

- **Realize value.** A well-defined cloud adoption strategy helps you realize the full value of your cloud investments. Optimize cloud investments to provide financial efficiency, cost optimization, and business agility.
- **Ensure business-driven decisions.** Align cloud adoption with business goals to maximize value and support measurable outcomes.
- **Drive alignment among cross-functional teams.** Foster collaboration among business, IT, and finance teams to achieve unified goals.
- **Mitigate modernization risks.** Create a roadmap to safely rearchitect legacy systems and integrate cloud technologies.

- **Enable continuous strategy improvement.** Use a well-defined and continuously evolving cloud adoption strategy to better address challenges, like unexpected costs, siloed work environments, and unrealized cloud investment value.

How to build a cloud adoption strategy?

This guidance helps you develop a cloud adoption strategy that aligns with your business goals. The guidance is organized into five steps, suitable for both enterprises and startups:

1. **Assess your cloud adoption strategy.** Evaluate your organization's readiness for cloud adoption.
2. **Define your motivations, mission, and objectives.** Identify the reasons for adopting cloud technologies.
3. **Define your strategy team.** Identify the individuals and teams who will build and execute your strategy.
4. **Prepare your organization.** Get leadership and executive buy-in, align your organizational strategies, understand your operating model's readiness for cloud, and consider a shift to a product model.
5. **Inform your strategy.** Discover strategic considerations for key cloud areas, such as financial efficiency, AI, resiliency, security, and sustainability.

Use the following checklist to guide you through the cloud adoption strategy steps.

Cloud adoption strategy checklist

The following checklist provides an overview of the tasks for each cloud adoption strategy step. Focus on the startup tasks if your organization is smaller and has fewer resources. Focus on the enterprise tasks if your organization is larger and has extensive resources. Some tasks correspond to both scenarios.

 Expand table

Cloud adoption strategy step	Startup tasks	Enterprise tasks
Assess your cloud adoption strategy	☐ Assess your strategy	☐ Assess your strategy
Define your motivations, mission, and objectives	☐ Define your motivations ☐ Define your mission and objectives ☐ Measure success	☐ Define your motivations ☐ Classify your motivations ☐ Define your mission and objectives ☐ Measure success

Cloud adoption strategy step	Startup tasks	Enterprise tasks
Define your strategy team	☐ Define your team	☐ Define your team
Prepare your organization	☐ Ensure leadership and executive buy-in	☐ Ensure leadership and executive buy-in ☐ Align organizational strategies ☐ Understand your operating model's readiness ☐ Shift from a project model to a product model ☐ Identify and define partner relationships
Inform your strategy	☐ Integrate AI ☐ Address security	☐ Ensure cost efficiency ☐ Integrate AI ☐ Create resiliency ☐ Address security ☐ Adopt sustainability

Next step

[Assess your cloud adoption strategy](#)

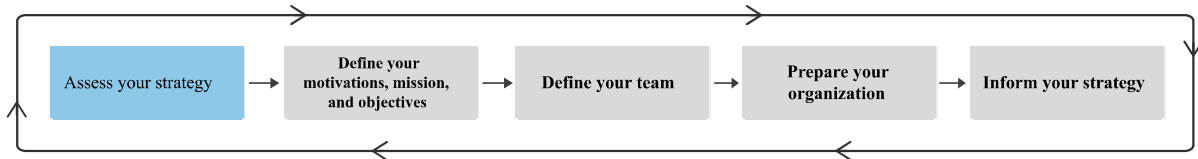
Last updated on 03/02/2026

Assess your cloud adoption strategy



Summarize this article for me

This article outlines a process to assess your existing cloud adoption strategy. Use assessment feedback to inform your organization of your current cloud maturity, identify gaps, and improve.



Every cloud journey is unique, and you should align your strategy with your business goals. You must optimize your cloud adoption strategy and implementation plan when you migrate or innovate in the cloud. You can choose between several cloud services and pathways for cloud adoption. Understand your options to choose the right solution for your organization.

Assessment review tool

To assess your current cloud strategy posture, use the [Cloud Adoption Strategy Evaluator](#) assessment tool.

 [Learn](#) [Discover](#) [Product documentation](#) [Development languages](#) [Topics](#) [Sign in](#)

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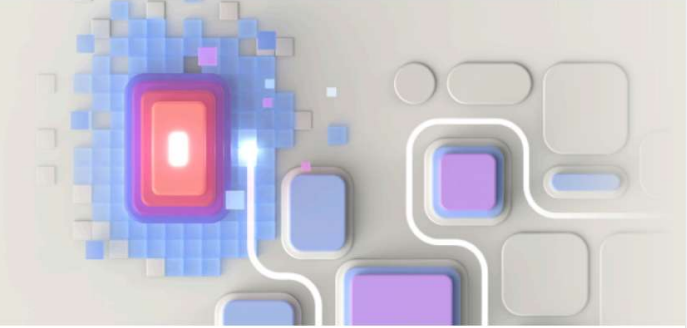
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MICROSOFT ASSESSMENTS

Cloud Adoption Strategy Evaluator

Assess your cloud adoption strategy and get recommendations for building or advancing your cloud business case.

[Start Assessment](#)



**Length of assessment**

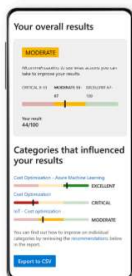
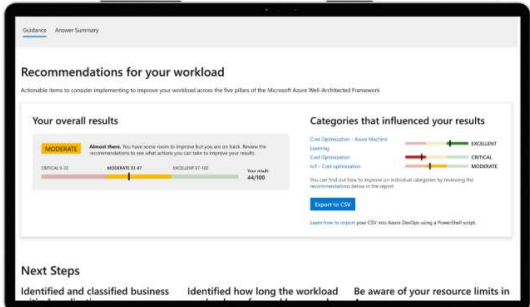
10 minutes

**Format**

Multiple choice and multiple response questions.

**Results**

Receive curated and personalized **guidance** that fits your specific scenarios.



TAKE ACTION

Improve your score over time

After completion of assessment, you will receive pragmatic recommendations based on your specific needs. Over time, you can improve your score by following these personalized recommendations.

[See results example](#)

Follow these steps to assess and document your cloud adoption maturity:

1. **Assess maturity:** Use the [Cloud Adoption Strategy Evaluator assessment](#).
2. **Identify gaps:** Discover gaps in your current cloud adoption strategy and document them.
3. **Get guidance:** Define action points based on the gaps that you identify. Educate your business about action points and information to implement in your new or updated cloud strategy. Use guidance from the assessment to address gaps.
4. **Iterate plans:** Repeat this assessment as your cloud adoption strategy matures. Iterate and refine as necessary across the lifecycle of your cloud footprint.

Next step

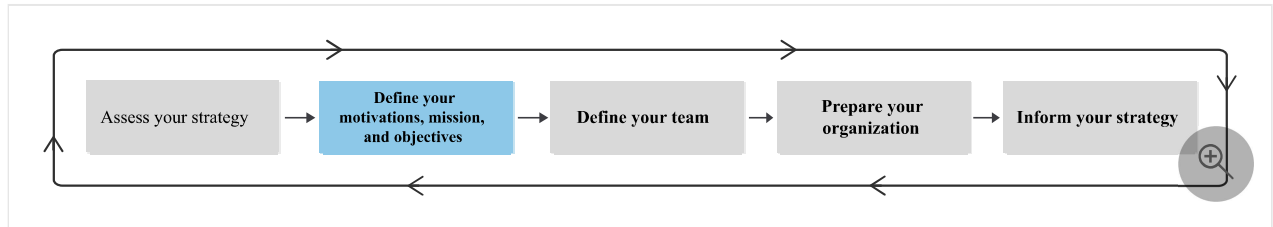
Determine your motivations to move to or expand in the cloud

Determine your motivations, mission, and objectives



Summarize this article for me

This article helps you understand and define motivations, mission, and objectives for your cloud adoption strategy. These are crucial for IT decision-makers and executives because they help ensure alignment with strategic business objectives, maximize return on investment, and inform decisions.



Define your motivations

Motivations for adopting and expanding your cloud footprint can vary. The following motivations are common examples that you might encounter. Use these examples to guide your decision making and inform your strategy.

Reduce business risk

- **Security:** Use advanced security offerings to protect your assets.
- **Sustainability:** Achieve carbon savings and enhance green IT compliance.
- **Resiliency:** Increase redundancy and resilience through cloud capabilities, including multiregion deployments.
- **Business continuity:** Use the capabilities of the cloud for high availability and uptime guarantees. Establish disaster recovery (DR) routines by using reliable backup and recovery solutions.
- **Datacenter modernization:** Modernize infrastructure by reducing hardware and staffing. Upgrade by migrating to Azure for enhanced capabilities.
- **Data governance:** Minimize risks by implementing robust data governance. This approach helps ensure compliance and security across decentralized data sources.

- **Compliance management:** Minimize compliance risks by using policies that block or alert deployments that don't align with your compliance requirements.
- **Financial transparency:** Gain visibility into financial aspects of cloud investments for leadership teams, including detailed billing and usage reports.
- **Cloud scale:** Use the cloud's built-in redundancy and DR capabilities to help ensure business continuity and mitigate operational risks.

Accelerate innovation

- **AI:** Access cutting-edge AI capabilities for transformative solutions.
- **Cloud native:** Benefit from cloud capabilities not available on-premises.
- **Security:** Use robust security controls to securely enhance innovation.
- **Customer solutions:** Develop software as a service offerings and consumer apps efficiently.
- **Shared responsibility:** Focus IT efforts on delivering business value.
- **Data empowerment:** Use accessible data to democratize insights. This strategy drives rapid, data-driven innovation across teams.
- **Compliance empowerment:** Apply policies to make compliance a feature of the solutions that you develop instead of an assessment that they need to pass later.
- **Cost flexibility:** Use the pay-as-you-go cost model to easily drive short-term innovative projects and proof-of-concept solutions without owning anything when you shut them down.

Enhance agility and efficiency

- **Profitability improvement potential:** Accelerate business growth and optimize investments through operational efficiency, cloud innovation, enhanced security, flexibility, and scalability.
- **Multicloud opportunities:** Support multicloud strategies by using Azure integration.
- **Rapid prototyping:** Quickly prototype and access services like AI and robotic process automation.
- **Simplified operations:** Use consistent tooling and platforms across your workloads to improve visibility and enable collaborative work across technical disciplines.

- **Decoupled data services:** Use decoupled data services, which are independent and scalable. These services free application architecture from data dependencies and enable agility in application development.
- **Cloud scale:** Use modern capabilities to scale up and down according to your business requirements.
- **Software-defined compliance:** Infrastructure as code and software-based policy controls allow you to more easily adjust to regulation changes.

Classify motivations

After you identify your motivations and key considerations, you need to assess and prioritize your needs. Follow these steps when you document your motivations:

- **Assess needs:** Identify which motivations align with your organization's strategic goals.
- **Prioritize:** Define the priority and urgency for each line item in each motivation.
- **Iterate and review:** Revisit and adjust priorities regularly as the business needs change. When you later define your mission and goals, link them to your motivations and expand as necessary.

Example classification

The following table lists examples of classifications of motivations and key considerations that are linked to business priority and urgency.

 Expand table

Motivation category	Consideration	Priority	Urgency
Reduce business risk	Security	High	High
Reduce business risk	Sustainability	Medium	Low
Reduce business risk	Resiliency	High	Medium
Accelerate innovation	AI	High	High
Accelerate innovation	Customer solutions	High	Medium
Enhance agility and efficiency	Maximize investments	High	High

Use your classified motivations to inform the priorities and urgency of your goals.

Define your mission and objectives

For a successful cloud adoption, you must define your mission and objectives. A clear mission provides direction and purpose. The objectives outline the steps that you take to achieve that mission. A mission is only valuable if you can take action on it, achieve objectives effectively, and measure the results.

ⓘ Note

The following section uses OKRs to show examples of how you can break down your cloud adoption strategy objectives into measurable key results. But you can use this guidance and these examples with any methodology or framework when you define and measure your business goals.

Mission statement and objectives

Your cloud adoption strategy should clarify the role of the cloud within your organization. It should also define how and when you apply the cloud to support the objectives and outcomes of your business, digital, and IT strategies.

Mission statement

A mission statement helps you align your objectives and key results to your organization's overall business mission.

To help you derive a statement for your business, consider these initial questions:

- **Why:** Why are you moving to or expanding in the cloud?
- **What:** What are your business objectives?
- **How:** How do you intend to measure success?

Use the answers to these questions to help define your mission statement for your cloud strategy. For example:

- **Mission statement:** "Use cloud technologies that align with our business and IT goals to empower our organization to innovate, scale, and deliver secure, high-quality services."

Objectives

Ensure that your objectives include clear and inspiring goals that align with the mission statement. For example:

- **Objective for security:** "Use advanced security offerings to protect your assets."
- **Objective for compliance:** "Use advanced compliance offerings to audit your assets."
- **Objective for datacenter modernization:** "Modernize infrastructure with reduced hardware and staffing. To upgrade the datacenter, migrate to Azure for enhanced capabilities."

Recommendations:

To define your mission and objectives, consider the following recommendations.

- *Meet with and involve key stakeholders across your organization.* Ensure that you clearly represent the business and departmental mission and objectives and that all stakeholders understand them. You might include problem statements that a cloud adoption addresses.
- *Define and align cloud adoption objectives and key results.* Clearly define, refine, and align the cloud objectives with your organization's mission and objectives.
- *Define key results for objectives.* After you define and align objectives, establish specific key results to achieve the objectives, including key performance indicators (KPIs), to measure progress.
- *Establish accountability.* Assign accountable roles to key results and review key results and associated KPIs periodically, preferably quarterly.
- *Prioritize clarity.* Ensure that your objectives, key results, and accountability are clear, concise, and accessible to everyone.

Measure success

To understand if you're on track to meet your objectives, you must effectively measure and track your key results. Establish KPIs or other ways to gauge progress on your mission and objectives.

These metrics should provide insights into your progress against each key result and highlight areas for improvement.

Recommendations:

To measure your success, use these guidelines when you define metrics.

- *Define KPIs.* Set clear metrics that you can measure against each related key result.
- *Review regularly.* Schedule and perform regular reviews to assess progress.

- *Be agile.* Iterate and adjust your strategy and ways to measure progress. Cloud innovation rapidly changes the technical landscape and the opportunities to apply clever solutions.

Example objectives and success metrics

 Expand table

Motivation	Objective	Key result	Success metrics or KPIs
Reduce business risk	Security: Use advanced security offerings to protect your assets.	Achieve a 35% reduction in security incidents within the next 12-month period.	Track incident reports and response times.
Reduce business risk	Security: Use advanced security offerings to protect your assets.	Implement data encryption across all platforms within the next 6-month period.	Audit encryption coverage and effectiveness monthly.
Reduce business risk	Compliance: Use advanced compliance offerings to audit your assets.	Achieve a 35% reduction in compliance audit findings within the next 12-month period.	Track compliance audit results and remediation activities.
Reduce business risk	Reliability: Improve the availability of cloud-based applications.	Achieve a 50% reduction in P1 incidents within the next quarter.	Track service-level agreement compliance, incident tickets logged, and help desk call volumes.
Enhance agility and efficiency	Investments: Optimize investments through cloud scalability and agility.	Reduce IT infrastructure spend by 20% through resource optimization in the cloud within the next 12-month period.	Analyze cost management and resource usage reports.
Enhance agility and efficiency	Investments: Optimize investments through cloud scalability and agility.	Use automated cost monitoring to identify savings opportunities.	Track cost anomalies and corrective actions that you take.
Reduce business risk	Sustainability: Achieve carbon savings and enhance green IT compliance.	Reduce carbon footprint by 20% through optimized cloud operations.	Monitor emissions reports for your deployed Azure infrastructure.
Reduce business risk	Data: Ensure data integrity.	Achieve 100% compliance with data retention and security policies.	Track the percentage of data audits that pass without incidents.

Motivation	Objective	Key result	Success metrics or KPIs
Accelerate innovation	AI: Access cutting-edge AI capabilities for transformative solutions.	Launch two new AI-driven products within the next 18-month period.	Monitor product development times and market feedback.
Accelerate innovation	AI: Access cutting-edge AI capabilities for transformative solutions.	Implement AI-driven analytics to improve decision-making by 45%.	Evaluate data accuracy and decision-making speed improvements.
Accelerate innovation	AI: Access cutting-edge AI capabilities for transformative solutions.	Decrease customer ticket response times by deploying a new AI-based customer support system within the next 12-month period.	Monitor customer satisfaction (CSAT) and ticket resolution times.
Accelerate innovation	Security: Use advanced security offerings to protect your assets.	Increase security automation to cover 80% of threat detection.	Track automated versus manual threat detections.
Accelerate innovation	Data: Enhance data accessibility.	Increase data accessibility for 90% of teams by Q3.	Track the percentage of teams that have self-service access to key data.
Enhance agility and efficiency	Rapid prototyping: Quickly prototype and access services like AI and robotic process automation.	Reduce time-to-market for new services by 20% within the next 12-month period.	Compare launch timelines before and after cloud adoption.
Enhance agility and efficiency	Developer velocity: Give engineering teams the ability to create and manage dev/test environments.	Create a self-service process to automatically deploy compliant dev environments.	Monitor the time from the request to environment readiness, the time that admin teams spend servicing requests, and the security compliance of dev environments.
Enhance agility and efficiency	Datacenter modernization: Modernize infrastructure with reduced hardware and staffing. Upgrade by migrating to Azure for enhanced capabilities.	Increase datacenter efficiency by 25% by using virtualization in the cloud.	Evaluate resource usage and operational costs, and continuously rightsize.
Enhance agility and efficiency	Datacenter modernization: Modernize infrastructure with reduced hardware and staffing. Upgrade by	Transition to a serverless architecture for 45% of new applications in the next 12-month period.	Evaluate deployment speed and resource usage.

Motivation	Objective	Key result	Success metrics or KPIs
	migrating to Azure for enhanced capabilities.		
Enhance agility and efficiency	Data: Decouple data services from the application architecture.	Provision independent, scalable data services for 75% of development teams by Q3.	Track the percentage of applications that use decoupled data services.

Next step

Define your team for cloud adoption

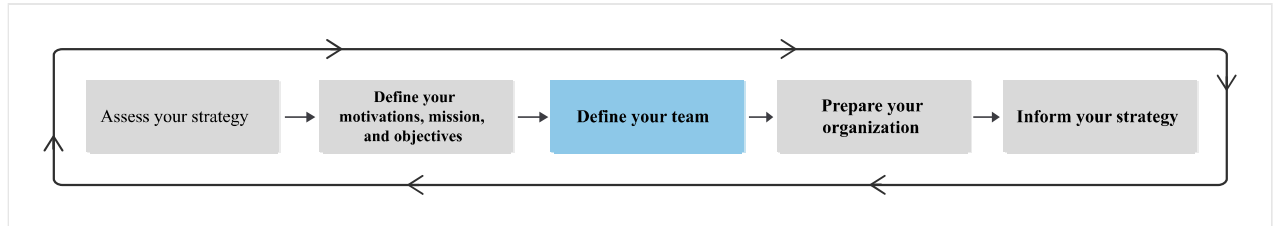
Last updated on 02/10/2026

Define your cloud strategy team



Summarize this article for me

This article outlines the process for defining your cloud strategy team. A cloud strategy team or function defines the motivations and business objectives for cloud adoption and transformation projects. These functions validate and maintain alignment between business priorities and cloud adoption efforts.



Establishing a *motivation-driven strategy* helps align initiatives with business objectives. The cloud strategy team facilitates alignment between the business and the adoption initiatives.

Why do I need a cloud strategy team?

Consider these reasons for establishing a cloud strategy team:

- *Align business and IT objectives.* Ensure that your cloud initiatives are purpose-driven, are tied to your motivations, and address specific business needs and priorities.
- *Improve strategic decision making.* Bring diverse perspectives to evaluate cloud capabilities and select solutions that are aligned with organizational goals.
- *Accelerate cloud transformation.* Streamline the adoption process by creating a cohesive roadmap and clear ownership of initiatives.
- *Reduce operational risks.* Identify and mitigate potential challenges in security, compliance, and governance.
- *Enhance innovation and flexibility.* Foster a collaborative environment that encourages innovative uses of cloud technology and increases responsiveness to market changes.

Recommended functions

To implement a cloud strategy team and realize value from cloud investments, include these functions. You can start small and expand the team over time. Start by consulting stakeholders from across the organization and add more functions to your adoption strategy team as necessary.

Here's a list of typical functions and their relevance for a cloud adoption strategy:

- *Central IT* helps manage operational efficiency, optimizes IT resources, prepares the technical platforms, and ensures the scalability and availability of cloud services.
- *Business decision makers (BDM)* ensure that cloud strategies drive business value and align with revenue generation, customer engagement, and operational goals.
- *IT decision makers (ITDM)* bridge the gap between technology and business. They help balance technological feasibility with business needs and ensure that new solutions align with existing IT frameworks and capabilities.
- *Lead architects* translate the business objectives into technical architectures that ensure cloud solutions are secure, scalable, reliable, and adaptable.
- *Cloud security teams* ensure you protect your data and systems. They ensure that new initiatives follow security standards to reduce cloud adoption risks.
- *Compliance teams* minimize legal and compliance risks. They help ensure that all cloud practices meet regulatory and organizational compliance standards.
- *Financial teams* inform IT and business decision makers about the opportunities and risks of cloud investments.
- *Executives* provide top-down support and strategic oversight. Including someone from your leadership team or executive stakeholders can help drive organizational commitments to ensure that cloud adoption aligns with the company's overall mission and strategic objectives.

Seek input

Your cloud strategy team should continuously seek input from across the business. Consider ensuring alignment and seeking input from these additional teams and personas:

- *Finance leadership* guides budgeting, cost management, and financial planning. They help maximize the return on cloud investments by ensuring financial efficiency and compliance with corporate financial policies.
- *Marketing* shapes brand reputation and customer engagement strategies. They ensure that cloud capabilities support customer acquisition, retention, and digital marketing initiatives to enhance overall brand image.
- *Sales* drives revenue growth and builds customer relationships. They align cloud solutions with sales goals to streamline sales processes, boost efficiency, and improve customer lifetime value.
- *Human resources (HR)* provides insights and support that directly influence the success and sustainability of the transformation. If you have recruitment, re-skilling, or workforce planning requirements because of new areas for innovation, HR is a crucial partner.
- *Executive leadership* helps you meet market growth requirements and environmental sustainability metrics.
- *Sustainability leads* drive sustainability as part of the cloud strategy throughout the business, ensuring sustainability is aligned with the company's environmental

commitments.

Recommendations

- *Start small and expand.* Define the core members of the initial team. Core members at this stage typically include IT, finance, and security. Seek input from other functions as necessary for the first iterations of your strategy.
- *Define the role of your strategy team.* Ensure that you map your business requirements and objectives to the operational responsibility of the cloud adoption strategy team. A clear accountability structure helps when you communicate organizational changes or invest in new initiatives to enhance your cloud maturity.
- *Review the strategy team memberships.* Regularly review the strategy team to ensure representation across the business and the right stakeholders and collaborators are involved. Doing so helps uncover both opportunities and risks. Both should be fairly represented as the strategy evolves.
- *Iterate on your strategy.* Create an initial strategy draft with your core team, consulting with business leaders and stakeholders. Use the first iteration to explore business goals that you can achieve through cloud adoption. When you have executive support to proceed, expand the scope and detail of your strategy team as necessary.

Next step

Prepare for organizational alignment

Last updated on 03/02/2026

Prepare for organizational alignment

Article • 02/03/2025

Organizational alignment is important to ensure a collective buy-in to the strategies you're planning to execute on. To ensure you have the required support throughout your cloud adoption journey, consider getting a few key stakeholders involved early on, and expand your leadership buy-in as you iterate on your strategy execution.

Leadership and executive buy-in

You identified the motivations and business objectives to support your organization's mission. Now you need to ensure that your leadership is aligned to that vision and strategy.

If you don't have leadership buy-in for your adoption strategies and plans, it can result in several significant risks.

Recommendations:

- *Align leadership with strategic goals:* Help your leadership better understand and justify the investments into adoption projects, ensuring they're fully aware of the benefits, challenges, and risks.
- *Obtain the required resources:* Adoption projects often require significant investments in technology, talent, and time. Secure leadership buy-in to obtain the necessary resources for your projects.
- *Communicate leadership buy-in:* Change can be challenging for many employees as digital transformation and adoption projects accelerate. Reduce resistance to change by ensuring leadership buy-in is promoted and communicated to the organization, enhancing employee adaptability.

Align organizational strategies

If you already have existing organizational strategies, the alignment between your business, digital, IT, and adoption strategies is crucial for a successful cloud adoption initiative, whether you've already got a footprint in the cloud or not.

The **business strategy** typically defines the organization's high-level mission and goals, market positioning, and competitive approach. This typically aims to drive revenue growth, customer satisfaction, and cost efficiency.

The **digital strategy** typically defines how technology transforms your business processes, customer interactions and offerings to enable digital growth and innovation.

The **IT strategy** typically defines how technology infrastructure and resources support your business goals, focusing on operational efficiency, security, and modernization.

If your organization has these strategies in place already, ensure the adoption strategy supports the goals of existing organizational strategies and missions. Even if some of these strategies aren't in place, having a conversation with key business or IT stakeholders regarding the ambitions or objectives in these areas is important to drive strategy alignment. This alignment can help to:

- Complement your technology roadmap and infrastructure modernization initiatives.
- Allow IT to better support both business and digital goals more effectively.
- Support the goals and objectives, such as agility, growth, cost efficiency, and customer experience and satisfaction.
- Help accelerate your initiatives like data-driven insights, product innovation, or digital customer experiences.

Recommendations:

- *Regularly review strategy alignment:* Ensure you regularly check-in with business, digital, and IT-leaders to keep your cloud initiatives aligned with evolving goals.
- *Agile feedback loops:* Use agile practices to gather feedback from key stakeholders and leaders, and quickly revisit and adapt your strategies to meet changing needs.

Understand your operating model's readiness for cloud

For an organization to efficiently utilize the benefits of cloud in a modernized way, they need the organizational capabilities (People, Processes, Technology, and Partners) to do so. When defining a cloud adoption strategy, you need to know what your current capabilities are to prepare for and inform the development of your adoption strategy.

An organization's operating model is essentially how an organization structures itself to meet its strategic objectives to provide value to its customers and stakeholders. A full operating model represents all the value streams, capabilities, organizational structures, management systems, information systems, delivery partners and locations.

Understanding your organization's current operating model plays a crucial role in developing your cloud adoption strategy:

- *Organizational capabilities and processes:* Organizations with traditional support, technical change, security, finance, and architecture capabilities might have significant difficulty in keeping up with the continuous change and scale brought on by cloud services. The adoption strategy in this case needs to factor in the evolution of these capabilities to effectively support and enable cloud.
- *Organizational culture:* Highly regulated or risk-adverse organizations might have a non-collaborative and command and control culture. Cloud might introduce resistance to change in the ways of working. The cloud adoption strategy needs to factor in how to address the organization's culture needs to enable the benefits of cloud.
- *Roles and skills:* Organizations that are primarily on-premises might lack expertise in cloud architecture, DevOps, and cloud-native security practices. The cloud adoption strategy needs to factor in the training and skilling plan to address the adequate adoption and enablement of cloud services.

It's important that leadership identify and acknowledge their current limitations across their existing operating model for the cloud adoption strategy to provide suitable attention and resourcing for the plan the cloud journey.

Recommendations:

- *Understand the current operating model:* Evaluate the organization's current capabilities and structures either through a workshop with leadership or through a third party and benchmark your organization's current operating models' readiness for cloud.
- *Identify gaps:* Based on the benchmark, hold a workshop with leadership to identify the readiness gaps for cloud and the strategic objectives and determine how the cloud adoption strategy needs to be aligned.
- *Ensure all key stakeholders are informed:* Ensure all key stakeholders are informed and aligned on the gaps and the risks regarding cloud adoption and ensure these are suitably addressed during the planning stage (link to CAF plan).
- *Continuously review:* Continue to conduct benchmarks and workshops with leadership to continually review readiness along the journey so that progress can be measured, and the strategy can be adapted iteratively.

Shift from a project model to product model

Organizations moving or expanding their footprint in cloud who are wanting to ensure they can broadly scale their cloud services at speed might need to shift from a

traditional project delivery model to a product delivery model for operations.

This shift is a fundamental change in how business' structure, develop, and manage IT and technology investments as part of a cloud adoption strategy.

- *A project model:* Task-driven against a clearly defined scope, clear start and end time frames, and a budget typically focused on CAPEX. Once projects are complete, the ownership often shifts to another team for operations and maintenance.
- *A product model:* Focuses on solutions as continuously evolving assets which require ongoing value delivery. It's an outcome-driven model with cross functional teams taking end to end ownership of development, operations, and governance. This model enables more responsive and scalable value delivery.

Key benefits of a product delivery model

- *Democratization and scalability:* A product delivery model ensures all cloud platform teams services are productized to make them more easily consumable and accessible to all parts of the organization to drive cloud adoption and maturity.
- *Drives innovation:* Product models align with cloud-native technologies, making it easier to experiment, scale, and roll out new features.
- *Business alignment:* Continuous value delivery helps ensure the technology investments stay aligned with business goals.
- *Fosters collaboration:* Encourage cross-functional collaboration across technical and business teams to drive business outcomes more effectively.

Examples of what the shift looks like

- **Focus:** A project delivery model is focused on completing tasks and delivering a "finished" solution, whereas a Product delivery model is focused on ongoing improvements and continuous value delivery.
- **Outcomes:** A project delivery model's outcome is typically based on a completed solution at a point in time versus a product delivery model's outcomes based on a continuously evolving service.
- **Ownership:** A project delivery model usually has temporary project teams with a clearly defined end date, versus a product delivery model which has persistent

product teams responsible for the lifecycle of the service.

- **Team structures:** Project delivery models typically have isolated, temporary project teams, while product delivery models have cross-functional, stable product, platform, and enablement teams.

The project-to-product delivery model shift directly informs the cloud adoption strategy by redefining how the organization plans, executes, and maintains its cloud initiatives. It ensures the principles of continuous improvement, customer-centricity, and collaboration are embedded. This ensures that cloud investments provide lasting, strategic value rather than short-term, one-off results.

Recommendations:

Follow these recommendations to start shifting from a project to a product delivery model.

- *Understand your current structures:* Assess your organization's existing operating model capabilities and culture including things such as delivery functions, funding approaches (CAPEX or OPEX driven), and team structure models. Hold a workshop with your leadership team to discuss these and document how you currently operate, then map out where you might see benefits in shifting to a product model.
- *Establish a target state:* Once your strategic objectives are clearly understood and aligned and you have evaluated your cloud culture and operating model, then identify the target state by which you need to transform across architecture, operations, governance and culture. Hold a workshop with your leadership team to work through this and identify the initiatives and program of work that would need to be in place to drive this forward.
- *Stakeholder awareness and leadership buy-in:* Engage key stakeholders to ensure they understand and support the project-to-product shift, including the cultural and operational changes it entails.
- *Set expectations:* Outline the cultural shift required for a product mindset, focusing on customer-centered thinking, continuous collaboration, and a focus on outcomes over deliverables.
- *Account for time and resources:* Ensure you have enough time and resources for the planning stages to determine how current gaps need to be addressed when moving from a project to product approach and establish a roadmap to enable this.

Identify and define partner relationships

Organizations moving or expanding their footprint in cloud might need to rely on both internal and external partners. These partners can help you execute your cloud adoption strategy and provide the necessary expertise and resources to ensure success.

Consider the following:

- *Identify key partners.* Identify the key partners that help you execute your strategy. You should include your cloud provider and providers of critical line-of-business applications and other infrastructure that is necessary for success.
- *Promote integrated partnerships.* Treat your cloud provider and key ISVs as part of an integrated partnership that can help you deliver your strategy, rather than as a supplier that's accountable for delivering to a contract.
- *Regularly meet.* Set up a regular cadence with stakeholders from partner organizations and understand how they contribute to meeting KPIs and KRs, as well as other opportunities for collaboration.

Next steps

Inform your cloud adoption strategy

Feedback

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